Ideation Phase

Defining the Problem Statements

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Project Name	Book a Doctor – Online Medical Appointment Platform
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Why This Exercise Matters

A clearly written customer problem statement helps the team land on the right solution for the real challenges users encounter. By putting ourselves in the position of each stakeholder — patient, doctor, and administrator — we can understand their goals, frustrations, and emotional state, so the Book a Doctor platform gets built around actual user needs instead of guesswork.

Stakeholders in Scope

The Book a Doctor platform supports three distinct types of users, each with its own goals and pain points:

- **Patient** — wants a quick and dependable way to find and book the right doctor.
- **Doctor** — needs a structured way to manage appointments and availability.
- **Admin** — is responsible for verifying doctors and protecting platform trust.

Customer Problem Statements

One problem statement was written for each core stakeholder, following the 'I am / I'm trying to / But / Because / Which makes me feel' framework.

Problem Statement — PS-1 (Patient)

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
a working professional who needs a doctor	book an appointment with a doctor I can trust, without delay	I have no way of knowing which doctors are actually available or qualified nearby	no single platform shows real-time doctor availability	Frustrated & Anxious

Problem Statement — PS-2 (Doctor)

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
a practicing doctor running my own schedule	keep patient appointments and records organized and efficient	manual phone calls and walk-ins keep clashing with bookings already on my calendar	there is no digital system that syncs my availability in real time	Overwhelmed & Disorganized

Problem Statement — PS-3 (Admin)

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
a platform administrator overseeing the doctor network	verify doctor credentials and keep an eye on platform activity	there is no central dashboard to approve or flag doctor profiles	doctor verification still happens manually, outside the system	Inefficient & Unsure

Problem Statement Summary Table

PS	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A working professional who needs a doctor	book an appointment with a trusted doctor quickly	I can't tell which doctors are free or qualified nearby	no single platform shows live doctor availability	Frustrated & Anxious
PS-2	A practicing doctor managing my own schedule	manage patient appointments and records efficiently	manual calls/walk-ins clash with existing bookings	there is no digital system to sync my availability in real time	Overwhelmed & Disorganized
PS-3	A platform administrator overseeing doctors	verify doctor credentials and monitor platform activity	I have no central dashboard to approve or flag doctor profiles	doctor verification is handled manually outside the system	Inefficient & Unsure

Cost of Leaving These Problems Unsolved

- Patients put off or skip care altogether because finding and booking a doctor is too much friction, which hurts health outcomes.
- Doctors burn time on scheduling conflicts and manual coordination, which cuts into how many patients they can see.
- Admins have no reliable way to confirm that only verified, qualified doctors appear on the platform, putting trust and safety at risk.

How These Statements Shape the Solution

Each problem statement feeds directly into a core feature of the Book a Doctor platform: PS-1 shapes the doctor search and live booking flow; PS-2 shapes the doctor's dashboard for managing appointments and schedules;
PS-3 shapes the admin verification dashboard. Together, they keep the MERN-based application anchored to real, emotionally grounded needs for every stakeholder, rather than being designed around assumptions.